

The Puzzle Tree Adventure

Little adventurers • 3-4 years old



Morning Map

The sun is warm on the window. Four friends sit on the carpet. Mia, Sam, Leo, and Noor are almost four. They wear bright socks. They giggle. A box sits in the middle. It is a puzzle box. The picture is a big, friendly tree.

« **We will make the tree,** » says Mia. Her eyes shine.

Sam opens the box. Pieces tumble out. They are big and colorful. Some pieces curl like leaves. Some pieces are round like apples.

« **No hurry,** » says Noor. « **We are a team.** »

Leo points to a paper. It is a tiny map. The map says, « **Find four special pieces.** » The children clap. An adventure begins.

They stand up. The living room is a land of soft mountains. The couch is a castle. The rug is a river. The lamp is a tall lighthouse. Each place might hide a puzzle piece.

« **Let's look,** » says Sam. He puts on a little explorer hat. Mia takes a magnifying glass. Leo grabs a toy shovel. Noor carries a small bag for treasure.

They tiptoe to the couch castle. They count three cushions. A cushion is warm. Under a cushion is a blue piece. « **Found one!** » they cheer. The blue piece glows like a small pond.

They cross the rug river. They hop on pillows like stones. Leo jumps high. He finds a green piece by the lamp lighthouse. « **Green leaf for the tree,** » he sings.

They explore the kitchen hill. The chair is a mountain. Mia climbs the chair. She finds a red piece near the cookie jar. « **A red apple!** » she says. They smile.

They look under the bookshelf cliff. Noor reaches with her long arm. Her hand finds a yellow piece with sparkles. « **Sun piece!** » she whispers.

Back on the carpet, they put the pieces together. The map shows where the pieces fit. The puzzle begins to grow. The tree gets a trunk. It gets leaves. It gets apples. The map has a tiny path. The path says, « **Three more pieces to find.** »

Garden of Socks

Outside, the backyard is a jungle of green. The grass tickles their toes. The garden hose is a winding river. A flower pot is an island. The sandbox is a golden desert.

They step into the sandbox desert. Little feet make soft prints. Leo digs with his shovel. He finds a purple piece, soft like a petal. « **Hello, purple!** » he sings.

The swing is a boat. The slide is a waterfall. They pretend to row across. Mia hums a tune. Sam hums back. Noor makes a tiny drum from a bowl. The world feels kind and bright.

« **Where next?** » asks Noor.

The laundry line becomes a forest. Socks hang like flags. A sock is a hiding place for treasure. Sam lifts a sock and finds a small orange piece. « **Orange sun,** » he says. The friends clap.

The map grows fainter. It shows a secret spot: the big cardboard box fort. They run to the fort. Inside, pillows make caves. Shadows are friendly. A stuffed bear smiles.

« **Look!** » Mia points. In the fort, under a pillow, is a shiny silver piece. It sparkles. « **The last piece,** » says Leo.

They gather the pieces. Each child holds one. They feel the weight of work. They feel warm and proud. The puzzle feels like a team hug.

Puzzle Party

Back on the carpet, the puzzle waits. The pieces make a circle. The children put each piece in its place. The tree grows taller and taller.

« **No rush,** » says Mia. « **We can try.** »

They try. Sometimes a piece fits right away. Sometimes a piece needs a tiny turn. They breathe. They smile. They help each other. Sam turns a tricky piece. Noor lifts a piece gently. Leo presses it down. The tree looks happy.

When the last piece clicks, all four clap. The tree shines like a picture in the sun. Little birds drawn on the puzzle seem to sing. The children laugh. The living room feels like a park.

They step back. The map folds into Mia's pocket. The tiny map had a secret message under a leaf. It reads, « **Friends make adventures.** »

Their grown-up comes in. « **What a clean castle,** » they say softly. « **What a big tree.** »

The friends jump into a group hug. « **We did it together,** » says Sam.

The grown-up brings warm milk and biscuits. They sit in a circle. Legs are cozy. The light is golden. The tree puzzle watches over them like a friendly giant.

« **Tell the story,** » whispers Noor.

Mia begins. « **We found a blue pond under the couch castle.** » Sam adds, « **We crossed the rug river on pillow stones.** » Leo giggles, « **We dug in the sandbox**

desert and found purple petals. » Noor finishes, « **And the socks in the laundry forest hid the orange sun. »**

They tell each line with soft voices. Each voice adds a sparkle. The story grows like the puzzle did.

Night comes slowly. The room grows soft and quiet. The puzzle shines faintly in the window light. The friends feel small and brave. They feel clever and kind.

« **One more look,** » says Leo.

They look at the tree. It reminds them of all the tiny things they saw. The leaves are simple shapes. The apples are bright dots. The trunk is a steady brown line.

« **Tomorrow we will make another map,** » says Mia. « **Or read more stories.** »

They sip their milk. They nibble their biscuits. The house hums a sleepy song.

Before they go to bed, the friends promise to play again. They promise to help each other. They promise to find new pieces, new maps, and new games in the same small, big world.

Their eyes grow heavy. The friends yawn. The grown-up tucks a blanket over the puzzle, like a gentle hill. The room is warm. The tree keeps watch.

« **Good night,** » they whisper together.

« **Good night,** » the house answers in a soft, kind way.

The quiz: did you understand the story well?

1) What do the friends find under the couch?

- A blue piece
- A red ball
- A toy car
- A pillow

2) What color is the apple piece they find?

- Green
- Red
- Blue
- Yellow

3) What do the friends pretend the swing is?

- A boat
- A car
- A train
- A plane

4) What do the friends do at the end of the story?

- They go to sleep
- They eat pizza
- They play outside
- They watch TV

Correct answers:

1) A blue piece 2) Red 3) A boat 4) They go to sleep

Glossary: complicated words in the story

Puzzle: A game or toy that you put together by connecting different pieces to make a picture.

Adventure: An exciting experience where you go somewhere new or try something different.

Explorer: A person who travels to new places to learn about them.

Treasure: Something valuable or special that you find.

Whispers: To speak very softly so that only a few people can hear.

Giggle: A light, silly laugh.